price' when the Soviet Union 'needs us more than we need the USSR [Union of Soviet Socialist Republics]'.[76] The Lok Dal also issued multiple statements criticising the Congress (I) on its Afghanistan policy, and the Swatantra Party leadership was 'absolutely appalled' in the way Gandhi had dealt with the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.[77]

Supporting Gandhi's alignment with the Soviet Union, however, were the various Indian communist parties, who had close to fifty seats in the Lok Sabha.[78] The communists, in fact, were resentful with the government's attempts at ameliorating its stand in light of domestic and international pressure and seeking an early Soviet withdrawal.[79] Within a week of the Soviet invasion, on 1 January 1980, the politburo of the Communist Party of India (Marxist), CPI (M) or just CPM, declared that 'to come in opposition to this Soviet help to Afghanistan is to give an alibi to the US imperialists and the Pakistani military dictatorship'.[80] Senior CPM leaders such as Samar Mukherjee and Harkishen Singh Surjeet offered die-hard support to Moscow, and by corollary, to Gandhi, on Afghanistan. Deriding anyone who put blame on the Soviet Union for repeating American, British, and Pakistani propaganda, Surjeet blamed the 'US imperialists and their policies' for 'the present state of affairs and for all that is happening in the region'.[81] He also criticised British foreign secretary, Lord Carrington, who was proposing a 'neutral' Afghanistan, for 'arguing the case of insurgents and in favour of Pakistan.'[82] As for Afghan opinion, the communists took support of Abdul Ghaffar Khan's ambiguous press statement (which Khan later retracted) that he supported the Soviet intervention.

Backing Surjeet was the CPI MP from West Bengal, Bhupesh Gupta, who dug into the Janata Party and the BJP for digressing from the heart of the matter, i.e. American imperialism and Pakistani dictatorship. 'My friends [Janata Party and the BJP] seem to be very much exercised over Afghanistan. The situation in Kabul is causing them, some of them, sleepless nights, it seems. But you should know that arms to Pakistan are coming in huge number and quantity. Modern weapons. Side by side, they would get nuclear capability to mount vicious, monstrous, pervasive threat to our country and to all the countries in the region in the interest of American imperialism' Gupta said.[83] The US Secretary of Defence, Harold Brown's visit to Beijing in 1980, according to Indian